

CivicView — Indiegogo campaign draft

Status: FINAL — locked June 5, 2026. Paste-ready for the Indiegogo campaign editor.

Platform: Indiegogo **Funding type:** Flexible (keep-what-you-raise) — recommended; see §1.

Funding goal: \$25,000 **Campaign length:** 35 days (recommended; Indiegogo allows up to 60)

Story angle: Civic infrastructure (non-partisan, builder voice) **Generated:** May 21, 2026 ·

Ported to Indiegogo + finalized: June 5, 2026 **Companion docs:**

- `docs/gofundme_draft.md` — the original GoFundMe-formatted draft (kept for reference)
- `docs/civicview_financial_model.xlsx` — full 5-year P&L behind the \$25K ask
- `frontend/components/HelpBuildThisView.js` — the public "Help build this" page the campaign links to for the line-item breakdown
- `..\Indiegogo images\` (sibling folder to the repo) — final campaign art: cover `civicview_cover_concept_v2.png` (21:6, text-free), thumbnail `civicview_indiegogo_thumbnail_v2_1400x1400.png` (official logo), story images 1–4

Why Indiegogo over GoFundMe: GoFundMe pages cap out at a short summary plus a few images, which fights a project whose whole pitch is "every number is sourced and auditable." Indiegogo gives a long, multi-section story with embedded images, reward/perk tiers, and a FAQ. We use **Flexible funding** so we keep every dollar raised even if we don't hit \$25K (no all-or-nothing risk), and **InDemand** lets the campaign keep accepting contributions after the initial window closes — which maps cleanly onto the milestone ladder in §2.

1. Campaign setup (the Indiegogo "Basics" + "Funding" steps)

Field	Value / recommendation
Campaign title	<code>CivicView: see what your government actually does</code> (49 chars — under Indiegogo's 60-char limit)
Tagline / card text	Every vote, bill, and rep in one place — plus a verified way to talk back

Field	Value / recommendation
Category	Community Projects (decided). If the create-form dropdown lacks that exact label, use Tech & Innovation → Software .
Funding type	Flexible — keep every dollar regardless of whether we reach goal. (Fixed funding refunds everyone if you miss the goal; we don't want that risk.)
Goal	\$25,000
Duration	35 days. Indiegogo's data favors 30–40-day campaigns; longer runs lose urgency.
Beneficiary / payee	CivicView, Inc. (Florida profit corporation, document #P26000027545, status ACTIVE; Benefit Corporation Articles of Amendment prepared and ready to file). Link the business bank account, not personal.
Location	Florida, USA
Pitch media	Cover: Indiegogo images/civicview_cover_concept_v2.png (3486×996, 21:6, text-free — Indiegogo darkens it and overlays the title). Thumbnail: Indiegogo images/civicview_indiegogo_thumbnail_v2_1400x1400.png (square, official logo). Video: still recommended — 60–90s founder voiceover (script in §7) historically lifts conversion 1.5–2×.
Indiegogo fees	5% platform fee + payment processing (~3% + \$0.30 per contribution). Budget 8% off the top vs. GoFundMe's tip-based model . The \$25K goal is what backers see; fees come out of disbursement (\$23K net — modeled in civicview_financial_model.xlsx , Assumptions rows 68–75).

Project-creation form (settled values)

Field	Value
Project name	CivicView
Project URL	indiegogo.com/projects/civicview — locked after publish
Project tags	civic tech, government, transparency, democracy, non-partisan, open data, elections, accountability (whichever exist in the picker)
Short description	A non-partisan window into U.S. government — every vote, bill, and rep in one place, plus a verified way to talk back. No ads, no VC, built in public, every dollar sourced.
Project thumbnail	Indiegogo images/civicview_indiegogo_thumbnail_v2_1400x1400.png
Cover image	Indiegogo images/civicview_cover_concept_v2.png
Contact email	civicview@civicview.app
Legal entity type	Business — CivicView, Inc. (FL doc #P26000027545)
Location / currency	United States / USD

Creating the project only makes a private draft. Publishing + collecting funds additionally requires Indiegogo's identity + business-bank verification — blocked on the EIN (due imminently) and the business bank account (Phase 1–2 of §5).

2. Story body (paste into Indiegogo → "Story")

What CivicView is

CivicView is a non-partisan civic-engagement platform that surfaces what your elected officials publicly say and do — voting records, sponsored bills, executive orders, public statements — and lets verified constituents respond in their own districts.

It's a window into government. Not a campaign tool. Not a news site. Not a partisan outlet. Just the actual public record, plus the structured ability for the people those officials represent to weigh in.

[Embed image: [Indiegogo images/4_hero_cover.png](#)]

The problem we're solving

You can't find out what your government is actually doing. Most Americans don't know who their state senator is. Most don't know how their U.S. representative voted on the last major bill. Most can't name the bills currently in committee that will affect their city. That isn't apathy — it's an information problem. The data exists, but it's scattered across hundreds of government websites, lobbyist databases, and paid news terminals. Representatives don't fear voters who can't see what they're doing, and voters can't hold representatives accountable when the cost of finding out is half a day of research per question.

You can't talk to your reps in a way that counts, either. The channels representatives use today to gauge what their constituents actually think are all broken in some way. Town halls self-select — only the loudest 50 people in a 750,000-person district show up. Phone-and-letter campaigns get astroturfed by lobbying groups with autodialers and paid mail mills. Social-media replies are anonymous, often automated, and full of out-of-district noise. Office surveys go only to people already on the mailing list. There is no district-scoped, identity-verified channel where a representative can see what their actual constituents — verified to live in their district — think about a specific bill or vote. Reps end up listening to whoever shouts loudest. Voters end up feeling unheard.

And the polling we rely on to understand each other doesn't hold up to scrutiny. A headline says "90% of voters agree on X" — and never mentions, in the same breath, that the sample was 300 self-selected respondents, or that the question was leading, or that the demographic mix was nothing like the country it claims to represent. Trust in polling has collapsed, and for good reason: methodology is hidden, sample sizes are small, and topline numbers get repeated as fact by influencers and news shows that never read past the chart. That's how

citizens end up walking into a voting booth confident in a "consensus" that was never real.

CivicView attacks all three. Every elected official's record — their votes, their sponsored bills, their public statements, their committee assignments — is in one place, free and searchable. The engagement layer is gated to verified citizens at real addresses in real districts, so when a rep sees "62% of your district opposes this vote," that number is built from verified constituents, not bots and not a 300-person panel. And every poll on the platform shows its sample size, its scope, and its participant verification status up front. Poll creators can attach optional demographic questions and anyone can break the numbers down by group — but only in aggregate, with small groups automatically hidden, so a breakdown can never finger an individual. Methodology *is* the headline.

What's already built

This isn't a pitch deck. It's a working product. As of today CivicView already ships:

- **All 50 states + 435 congressional districts** on an interactive U.S. map you can drill into
- **Every member of Congress** with profile photos, voting records, sponsored bills, and committee assignments
- **The President, Vice President, Cabinet, Supreme Court** — full executive + judicial branch coverage
- **All 50 states' legislators, governors, and statewide executives** — every sitting state legislator in the country, not just Congress
- **Candidates + elections in five states** — Florida, Texas, California, New York, and Pennsylvania carry federal candidate rosters with **live FEC fundraising totals**, state-legislative incumbents, 2026 election calendars, and (where applicable) statewide ballot measures
- **Demographic-aware polling** — a poll's creator can attach an optional, standardized demographic form (age, party, parental status, education, and more); anyone can then break the results down by group, shown **only in aggregate with small groups automatically hidden** so a cut can never identify an individual. Sample size, scope, and verification status are visible up front
- **Address-to-rep lookup** — paste your street address, get the people who represent you at every level
- **AI integration powered by Anthropic Claude** — plain-English translation for every federal bill (alongside the official Congressional Research Service summary), a "What was this vote?" explainer on every roll-call, a generated abstract on every executive order, semantic poll filter chips, and sentiment + tone classification on user comments. All cached per-bill / per-vote / per-EO so cost stays predictable as traffic grows.

- **Three-identity engagement system** — citizens, verified representatives, and declared candidates can all hold accounts with appropriate features for each role
- **Polls, comments, and "Verified citizen" labels** that let reps filter for their actual constituents instead of drowning in out-of-district noise
- **Modern security foundation** — Cloudflare WAF + DDoS protection, automated dependency scanning, static analysis, daily Postgres backups, two-factor authentication for sensitive accounts, documented incident-response runbook

[Embed image: [Indiegogo images/3_whats_shipped.png](#)]

You can use it right now at **civicview.app**. There's no waitlist for browsing; you can start exploring your district immediately.

Where CivicView fits among the civic tools that already exist

Civic tech isn't a blank field. GovTrack, Ballotpedia, and USAFacts have catalogued legislators, bills, and government statistics for years. BallotReady covers ballot races at scale. Each does part of what civic-information work needs, and you can use any of them today for free. CivicView's specific contribution is the engagement layer on top — verified, district-scoped constituents responding directly to the people who represent them, weighing in on bills and votes, asking questions on rep pages, all editorially neutral and structured to keep the conversation local to the district it actually affects. Browsing legislative data is table stakes. Bringing the conversation between citizens and the officials who represent them into one verified, district-scoped place is what's missing — and what CivicView is here to fill.

What the \$25,000 covers

CivicView's operating model is deliberately lean. There are no salaries in this budget. No marketing agencies. No investor carve-outs. And because the core data feeds are free, your money doesn't go to API rent — it goes to identity verification, legal groundwork, and the durability to run national-scale civic data through Year 2:

[Embed image: [Indiegogo images/1_where_your_money_goes.png](#)]

- **\$2,400** — ID.me identity verification setup (so "Verified citizen" badges become provably real, not self-attested; +\$1.50 per verified user thereafter)
- **\$1,050** — Federal trademark registration for CivicView across software, SaaS, and online-community classes (3 classes × \$350)
- **\$6** — DMCA agent registration (required for user-generated-content liability protection)
- **~\$2,700** — Benefit Corp formation + attorney review of Terms of Service + Privacy Policy + modest civic-tech launch outreach

- **\$2,400–\$6,000/year** — Google Civic Information API at scale (polling-place lookup, sample-ballot data, contact info that stays current automatically)
- **~\$300/year** — Render Pro hosting + Postgres (no cold-start delay, warm database — currently funded out of pocket; the campaign moves it onto the project)
- **~\$101/year** — Google Workspace (the civicview.app address the platform sends mail from)
- **\$15/year** — Domain renewal for civicview.app
- **~\$16,000** — Year-2 operating buffer so we never have to run an emergency campaign while subscription revenue ramps toward break-even

The legislative data itself is free. Federal records come from the official Congress.gov API, all 50 states' legislators from Open States' free tier, candidate fundraising from the FEC's OpenFEC API, and state court data from CourtListener. We engineered around the paywalls, so your contribution buys verification and durability — not data-broker subscriptions.

(One optional line is deliberately NOT in this \$25K: a Vote Smart Public-Facing License at \$4,850/year would add candidates' self-reported issue positions. We already ship neutral, sourced issue summaries derived from legislative records, so it's additive, not required — we'll revisit it only if subscription revenue supports it.)

Every line item above has a published source — you can audit the math at **civicview.app/help-build**.

What unlocks at what dollar amount

Because we're on **Flexible funding**, we keep every dollar — so these aren't all-or-nothing thresholds, they're the order in which your contributions get put to work. Backers can watch exactly where the money lands as the bar fills:

[Embed image: [Indiegogo images/2_funding_milestones.png](#)]

When the campaign reaches...	What unlocks
\$2,400	ID.me Relying Party application filed — real verified-citizen badges become possible
\$3,456	Federal trademark filing + DMCA agent registered (every one-time IP/legal item done)

When the campaign reaches...	What unlocks
\$6,456	Attorney review of Terms of Service + Privacy Policy commissioned
~\$9,300	Full Year-1 of recurring infrastructure (Google Civic at scale + hosting + email + domain) funded
\$25,000	Year-2 operating buffer secured — no emergency Year-3 campaign needed

Each milestone gets a public update on the campaign page as it's crossed. Donors love seeing exactly where their money went; we'd rather show it than hint at it. And if we pass \$25K, **InDemand** keeps the campaign open so the buffer keeps growing.

Where the money is *not* going

Just as important as the line items above is the absence of these:

- **No salaries.** Including the founder's. The fundraiser pays for infrastructure; it doesn't pay anyone a wage. If the project ever justifies salaried staff, that decision goes through a future fundraiser with its own explicit budget disclosure — not this one.
- **No marketing agencies, growth hackers, or paid acquisition.** Outreach happens through honest channels — the share copy below, the GitHub repo, civic-tech community word-of-mouth. If \$25K is going to get used on Facebook ads, we don't deserve \$25K.
- **No equity carve-outs, investor relations, or board observer seats.** Crowdfunding isn't a priced round. Backers get founding-supporter recognition and subscription credits — not stock.
- **No contracted developers.** Engineering is one person. Adding more hands later happens out of subscription revenue, not crowdfunding proceeds.
- **No executive comp, no offsites, no SaaS sprawl.** The paid lines are Render (hosting), Google Civic (at scale), and Google Workspace (email) — the frontend runs on Vercel's free tier. That's it. No company credit card funding miscellaneous "we'll figure it out" expenses.

Why this isn't ads-supported or venture-backed

CivicView is filing as a **Florida Benefit Corporation**. That's a legal structure that requires the company to consider its public-benefit purpose alongside shareholder interests — codified into our Articles of Incorporation, reviewable in the state public record.

No ads. Ads would mean advertisers pay to put content in front of constituents, which corrupts the editorial neutrality. The revenue model is a \$5/month subscription for the engagement features (creating polls on rep pages, commenting on posts) once verified accounts go live. Browsing is free, forever — informational access shouldn't sit behind a paywall.

No venture capital, either. VC-backed civic-tech has a track record of pivoting toward whatever pays — political ad-tech, data brokerage, partisan tools — once the runway runs out. Crowdfunding lets us stay accountable to citizens instead.

What CivicView is *not*

Civic tech is a crowded label, so it's worth being explicit about what CivicView is *not* doing:

- **Not a voter-registration drive.** We don't sign anyone up to vote, don't collect voter-registration data, don't push registration as a CTA. There are organizations that do that work well — go support them.
- **Not a candidate-endorsement tool.** We don't endorse candidates, don't run ads for candidates, don't rank candidates by preference. Every candidate gets the same surface treatment regardless of party, platform, or fundraising tier.
- **Not a campaign-donation platform.** We don't process political contributions, don't link to PACs or donor portals, don't surface fundraising totals.
- **Not a news site.** We don't generate editorial commentary on legislators or policies. The AI summaries translate official text into plain English; they don't argue about whether a vote was good or bad.
- **Not a data broker.** We don't sell user data. We don't sell aggregated anonymized engagement data either. The Privacy Policy commits to this in writing.

What you're getting

See the **Perks** column on this campaign — supporters at every tier get founding-supporter recognition + free-or-discounted subscriptions once verified accounts open.

Even if a perk isn't useful to you, every dollar above goal makes the platform more durable, not more expensive — more cushion against unexpected expenses, more headroom to add roadmap features as their costs come in, and less time spent fundraising instead of shipping.

Beyond contributing, the two things that genuinely help the project survive are these. **First, subscribe** at \$5 a month once verified accounts go live. The financial

model says the project breaks even at a 3% subscription rate among regular visitors; anything above 3% funds expansion to the rest of the country and the roadmap features further down. **Second, share the campaign and the platform** with anyone who cares about civic infrastructure. The more citizens and reps who join, the more useful the project becomes for everyone already on it. If you can't contribute, those two still move the needle.

About the builder

CivicView is built by **Jeffrey De La Nuez**, an independent developer based in Florida.

The idea for this app started years ago. I'd been listening — to representatives, to reporters, to social-media influencers — and at first I was genuinely enamored by the talk of change. But after years of it, I noticed something: nobody actually had a good way to connect with each other or surface real solutions to any of the problems that kept getting raised. Even people who followed political news closely couldn't name their own representatives, didn't know which bills were moving, and didn't really understand how the governing system worked.

I also kept getting fooled by polling. I'd see a headline — "90% of voters agree on this" — and only later realize the poll never disclosed how many people they actually asked. Sometimes it was 300. That kind of misleading framing led me astray more than once when I walked into a voting booth thinking I knew where the country stood.

And I kept watching newcomer candidates run into the same wall. Most races come down to whoever has the most money and the deepest connections, and that keeps good people with real ideas from ever running, because they know they can't compete on either axis.

About two months ago all of this finally clicked into one project. CivicView is my attempt to take all three problems on at once — informational, conversational, electoral. I'm building it because I have a solution-oriented mindset, because I take the integrity of the system seriously, and because I love this country and would rather build than complain. My hope is that this app helps American citizens come together with a clearer, more coherent picture of their own government — and that it pushes the polling and governing systems we rely on toward more transparency along the way.

The full source is on GitHub. There's no team yet — the design, the engineering, the moderation, the documentation, the financial model, all of it has been one-person work. The fundraiser pays for the infrastructure that lets one person ship and maintain national-scale civic data; it doesn't pay anybody a salary.

One last thing

Every dollar that comes in here is logged. Every line item is sourced. The 5-year financial model is published. The list of what's shipped (35+ items) and what's blocked on funding (the items above) is on the public site at **civicview.app/help-build**. You can audit the project before you fund it, and you can keep auditing it after.

That's the deal. Verified information, transparent funding, non-partisan tools. Help us ship it.

3. Perks (Indiegogo → "Perks" step)

Indiegogo perks are digital-only here (subscription credits + profile recognition), so set **"This perk does not require shipping."** Each needs an **estimated delivery date** — use **December 2026** (the verified-account + Stripe billing target) for every subscription perk.

Amount	Perk title	What's included	Est. delivery	Limit
\$5	Founding Citizen	2 months of CivicView subscription free once verified accounts open. "Founding Citizen" badge on your profile. <i>(Retail value \$10.)</i>	Dec 2026	Unlimited
\$50	Founding Citizen — Year One	1 year of CivicView subscription free. "Founding Citizen" badge + "1-year founder" credit on the /about page. <i>(Retail value \$60.)</i>	Dec 2026	Unlimited

Amount	Perk title	What's included	Est. delivery	Limit
\$200	Founding Citizen — Charter	5 years of CivicView subscription free. "Founding Citizen" badge + name in the /about credits + early access to verified-citizen onboarding (before public launch). <i>(Retail value \$300.)</i>	Dec 2026	First 100
\$500	Founding Citizen — Lifetime	Lifetime CivicView subscription. "Founding Citizen — Lifetime" badge + name in the /about credits + early access + a handwritten thank-you letter from the founder. <i>(Retail value \$1,200+ at average tenure.)</i>	Dec 2026 (letter: within 60 days of campaign close)	First 50

Small print to include verbatim in each perk description: *"Subscription perks are honored once the CivicView verified-account system + Stripe billing go live (target: Q4 2026). Until then, every supporter gets full access to the demo / preview environment with no subscription required. Subscription credits are tied to your verified account once you create one. If you delete your account, unused subscription time does not refund. CivicView, not Indiegogo, is responsible for fulfilling these perks."*

Note on the \$500 tier's handwritten letter: it's the only perk that physically ships. You can still mark the perk "no shipping" and collect the mailing address separately via Indiegogo's post-campaign survey, so backers aren't charged shipping.

4. FAQ (Indiegogo → add as the final section of the Story, or as individual FAQ entries)

Q: Where exactly does the money go? A: Every dollar goes into operating CivicView. No salaries, no profit distribution, no marketing agencies. The detailed line-item breakdown — with sources — is at civicview.app/help-build and in the 5-year financial model (`docs/civicview_financial_model.xlsx` in the public repo).

Q: Is CivicView affiliated with any political party, campaign, PAC, or government agency? A: No. CivicView is independent, filed as a Florida Benefit Corporation, and our editorial standards explicitly forbid endorsements of candidates, parties, or political positions. Read the standards at civicview.app/editorial-standards.

Q: Who decides what counts as "non-partisan" on the platform? A: The neutrality is enforced structurally rather than editorially. We don't write opinion pieces on legislators or policies. We don't endorse candidates. The AI summaries (powered by Anthropic Claude Haiku) translate official text — Congressional Research Service bill summaries, vote records, executive order text — into plain English without commentary on whether the underlying action was good or bad. Every elected official gets the same page treatment regardless of party. Every candidate gets the same composer regardless of party. The full editorial standards are published at civicview.app/editorial-standards. If you spot a violation, the Feedback button on the site goes straight to the moderation queue and corrections are logged publicly.

Q: What's a Benefit Corporation, and why does it matter here? A: A Benefit Corporation is a for-profit company with a legal obligation, written into its Articles of Incorporation, to consider the public-benefit purpose alongside shareholder interests. For CivicView, that public benefit is informed civic engagement and access to government information. The structure means a future buyer can't gut the mission without changing the corporate charter — a much higher bar than ordinary corporate governance.

Q: This is Flexible funding — what happens if you don't hit the \$25K goal? A: With Indiegogo Flexible funding, we keep every dollar contributed regardless of whether we reach \$25K (Indiegogo's 5% platform fee + payment processing still apply). If we fall short, we prioritize keeping the existing platform running (hosting + domain + security) and defer the discretionary line items (trademark, premium APIs) until subscription revenue catches up. Nothing about the contribution is contingent on hitting the goal.

Q: What if you overfund? A: There aren't named stretch goals on this campaign, because I'd rather not promise specific dollar amounts that aren't tied to real costs. What overfunding *does*

is make launch and ongoing operation more durable: a bigger cushion against unexpected expenses, more headroom to ship the roadmap features as their real costs come in, and less time spent fundraising instead of building. After the campaign window closes, **InDemand** keeps it open so contributions can continue. If you want to make sure CivicView launches successfully, contribute more. If you want to make sure it stays alive past launch, **subscribe** at \$5/month once verified accounts open — the project breaks even at a 3% subscription rate among regular visitors, and anything above 3% funds expansion and the roadmap. And whether or not you contribute, **share the campaign and the platform**.

Q: How do I redeem my subscription perk? A: Subscription perks activate once we ship the verified-account system + Stripe billing (target Q4 2026). When that lands, every backer will receive an Indiegogo update + email walking through verification + how to claim your subscription credit. Until then you can use the platform's demo / preview environment with no subscription required.

Q: What if CivicView shuts down before I get to redeem? A: We'd publish a wind-down notice on the site with at least 60 days of warning. Indiegogo perks are fulfilled by the campaigner (CivicView), not by Indiegogo, so this is a commitment we're making directly: if billing never launches, supporters won't be charged a subscription, and the demo environment stays open in the interim.

Q: Can I see the source code? A: Yes — the full backend + frontend source is on GitHub ([jeffreynuez/civicview](https://github.com/jeffreynuez/civicview)). Reading the code is the highest form of due-diligence.

Q: Why \$5/month for the eventual subscription? Why not free or ad-supported? A: Ads corrupt the editorial neutrality (advertisers gain leverage over what gets shown to whom). Free-forever doesn't sustainably cover ID.me verification (\$1.50/user), Render hosting at scale, Google Civic at scale, or email + domain. \$5/month is the floor that lets the project pay its own way without ads or VC compromise.

Q: Are contributions tax-deductible? A: No — CivicView is a Benefit Corporation, not a 501(c)(3) nonprofit, and Indiegogo contributions to it are not tax-deductible. We considered the nonprofit route but the IRS approval process takes 12–18 months and we'd rather ship now. If CivicView eventually qualifies for a public-benefit tax structure, we'll consider transitioning at that point.

Q: How can I help if I can't contribute? A: (1) Share the campaign with people who care about civic infrastructure. (2) Use civicview.app and submit feedback via the Feedback button — we triage everything. (3) If you're a developer, the GitHub repo accepts pull requests for state-data coverage outside Florida. (4) If you're a local official or campaign staffer, claim your rep or candidate page once verified accounts open.

5. Pre-publish launch checklist

Important sequencing note: ID.me's Relying Party contract requires the \$2,400 setup fee upfront — the application can't begin without it. That means the campaign is *funding* the ID.me onboarding, not the other way around. The sequence below reflects that dependency: stand up Postmark and the corporate / banking pieces first (all free or cheap), launch the campaign, then use the proceeds to onboard ID.me + Stripe live mode.

Phase 1 — Free / cheap pre-work (do now, no money required):

Postmark account created + Server set up + Server API Token grabbed (POSTMARK_API_TOKEN). Free 100 emails/month forever. Verify civicview@civicview.app as a Sender Signature, OR add DKIM + Return-Path DNS records for full domain verification.
EIN obtained (IRS.gov — free, instant if you have SSN; ~10 minutes online with the SS-4 form). Needed before you can open the business bank account.
Stripe account created in **test mode** — no EIN required for this step. Create the Product ("CivicView Citizen Subscription"), the \$5/mo Price, grab the test API key + a webhook signing secret. The whole subscription flow can be exercised end-to-end with Stripe's test card [4242 4242 4242 4242](#) before any real money moves.

Phase 2 — Corporate + banking (1–2 weeks):

Initial Profit Corp filing processed — Sunbiz document #P26000027545, status ACTIVE (CivicView, Inc.).
File the Benefit Corporation Amendment (Task #90) with Sunbiz once the initial filing is on the books. Articles language is in [docs/civicview_benefit_corp_filing.pdf](#).
Business bank account opened (need EIN + Articles of Incorporation + government ID + sometimes the Sunbiz tracking confirmation). Most online business banks (Mercury, Relay, Novo) approve in 1–3 business days. Brick-and-mortar banks can take a week.

Phase 3 — Launch the Indiegogo campaign:

Indiegogo account created and the **business** bank account linked via Indiegogo's payments setup (Stripe-backed; NOT personal — this matters for accounting and for the Benefit Corp ledger). Indiegogo requires identity + bank verification before a campaign can collect funds, so do this early.
Funding type set to **Flexible**, goal \$25,000, duration 35 days.
Category set to Community Projects (or Tech & Innovation → Software).
Cover + thumbnail finalized — [civicview_cover_concept_v2.png](#) (21:6, text-free) and [civicview_indiegogo_thumbnail_v2_1400x1400.png](#) in [Indiegogo images/](#).

Optional but recommended: record the 60–90s founder video (§7).
Story pasted in with the four images embedded at the markers in §2.
Perks configured exactly as in §3, each marked "no shipping" with a December 2026 estimated delivery date and the verbatim small print.
FAQ added as the closing section of the Story (or as Indiegogo FAQ entries).
Link to civicview.app/help-build cited in the Story.
Preview the campaign on desktop AND mobile before publishing — the image-embed positions and the perk card text both shift on mobile.
Decide launch timing — Tuesday or Wednesday morning (US Eastern) typically gets the best initial-day engagement.

Phase 4 — Once raised, deploy the proceeds in priority order:

First \$2,400 → ID.me Relying Party application. This unlocks verified-citizen accounts, which unlocks Stripe live mode (no point charging \$5/mo for engagement features until verified accounts can actually engage). Note: before paying the full \$2,400, double-check ID.me's current pricing — some Relying Parties qualify for reduced or staged pricing (civic-tech, nonprofit-adjacent, pilot programs). Worth a 10-minute call to ID.me's sales contact at id.me/business to confirm there isn't a smaller-footprint contract available for a pre-revenue Benefit Corp.

Next \$1,050 → Federal trademark filing (USPTO). Protect the CivicView name before the user base grows. Three classes (9, 42, 45) at \$350 each.

Then activate Stripe live mode. Submit business identity + bank account through Stripe's onboarding. They'll run a soft verification (no credit pull); usually live in <24 hours.

Then attorney review of Terms of Service + Privacy Policy (~\$1.5K–\$3K per the LEGAL-REVIEW-ROADMAP.md). Required before verified accounts can hold any subscription funds, before the ID.me Relying Party contract goes live, and before launching outreach.

Then provision at-scale paid tiers only as traffic warrants — primarily Google Civic Information API at scale. The legislative feeds (Congress.gov, Open States free tier, OpenFEC) are already live and free, so no API subscription gates the rep pages.

Remainder into the Year-2 operating buffer. Sits in the business account; no spending pressure.

At launch (the day the campaign goes live):

Share copy ready in §6 below — post to Twitter/X, LinkedIn, Reddit [r/civictech](https://reddit.com/r/civictech) and [r/programming](https://reddit.com/r/programming), civicview.app's home page banner.

Email your existing waitlist (whoever's already in the CitizenWaitlist table) with the campaign link.

Update the SHIPPED list on [/help-build](https://civicview.app/help-build) with a "Crowdfunding launched" entry linking to the Indiegogo URL.

Pin the Indiegogo link as a banner on civicview.app.
Reply to the first 20 contributions within 24 hours with a personal thank-you note (Indiegogo lets you message backers via Updates + direct messages).

Through the campaign:

Post an Indiegogo Update weekly (also shared to social) — momentum matters more than perfection. Campaigns that post updates raise meaningfully more than those that go quiet.

If you hit milestones (25%, 50%, 75%, 100%), post immediately.

When you cross \$2,400, post "ID.me application started" as a major milestone update.

Donors love seeing exactly where their money went.

When verified accounts ship, email all backers with the perk-redemption walkthrough.

At campaign close, switch on **InDemand** so contributions can continue toward the buffer.

6. Share copy

Twitter / X (280 chars):

Built CivicView in the open over the last 6 months — a non-partisan window into U.S. government. Verified citizens, verified reps, transparent funding. Crowdfunding the infrastructure now: [Indiegogo link]

No ads. No VC. No partisan agenda. Just the public record + tools to engage.

LinkedIn (longer-form post):

Civic infrastructure is broken. Most Americans can't name their state senator, can't tell you how their U.S. rep voted on the last major bill, and can't find their polling place without a Google rabbit hole. That's not apathy — it's a data problem. The information exists; it's just scattered, paywalled, and partisan.

Over the last six months I've been building CivicView (civicview.app) — a non-partisan platform that puts all 535 members of Congress, the President + Cabinet + SCOTUS, every state legislator in all 50 states, and 435 congressional districts in one place — plus candidates and live FEC fundraising in five states so far. Voting records, sponsored bills, public statements, AI-translated plain-English summaries, and demographic-aware polling. You can browse it right now.

What it doesn't have yet is the verified-citizen layer that turns the demo into a public utility. That's what the crowdfunding is for: \$25K covers Year 2 (ID.me verification,

Google Civic at scale, hosting, email, security, legal). The legislative data itself is free — Congress.gov, Open States, OpenFEC — so your money buys verification and durability, not API rent. No salaries. No marketing. Every line item is sourced and audited at civicview.app/help-build.

Filed as a Florida Benefit Corporation — legally obligated to weigh the public benefit alongside any shareholder interest. No ads, no VC, no partisan agenda. Just the public record + tools to hold reps accountable.

Link to support: [Indiegogo link]

Reddit r/civictech and r/programming:

[Title] CivicView — non-partisan civic data + engagement platform, fully working, crowdfunding the Year-2 infrastructure

Hey folks — for the last 6 months I've been building civicview.app, a non-partisan way to see what your elected officials actually do (votes, bills, statements) and to weigh in as a verified constituent.

The Phase 1 product is live and free: all 50 states map, all 535 members of Congress with photos + votes + sponsored bills, the entire executive + judicial branch, every state legislator in all 50 states, candidates + live FEC fundraising in five states, address-to-rep lookup, AI-translated bill summaries, and demographic-aware polling.

What's gated on funding: ID.me identity verification, Google Civic at scale, the legal review, and the Year-2 operating buffer — the legislative data feeds (Congress.gov, Open States, OpenFEC) are free. Total ask is \$25K with every line item sourced — breakdown at civicview.app/help-build.

Built as a Florida Benefit Corp (no ads, no VC), source on GitHub at [jeffreynuez/civicview](https://github.com/jeffreynuez/civicview). Happy to answer technical or product questions in the thread.

Indiegogo: [link]

Email to existing waitlist:

Subject: We're crowdfunding CivicView's Year-2 infrastructure

Hi —

You joined the CivicView waitlist some time ago, so this update is overdue: the product is live and free to browse at civicview.app. All 535 members of Congress,

the executive + judicial branch, every state legislator in all 50 states, candidates in five states, address-to-rep lookup, AI-translated bill summaries, and demographic-aware polling.

What hasn't shipped yet is the verified-account system that lets you create polls + comment on rep pages as a confirmed constituent. That's blocked on ID.me verification (\$2,400 setup + \$1.50/user) plus the legal review and a Year-2 operating buffer — the data feeds themselves are free.

We're crowdfunding it on Indiegogo. \$25K covers Year 2 of operations entirely — no salaries, no marketing, no VC, no ads. Every line item is sourced at civicview.app/help-build.

Backers at every tier get free-or-discounted subscription credits once verified accounts open: • \$5 → 2 months of subscription • \$50 → 1 year • \$200 → 5 years • \$500 → lifetime

Campaign: [Indiegogo link]

Thank you, Jeffrey De La Nuez Founder, CivicView

7. Pitch video script (recommended, 75 seconds)

[Screen recording: civicview.app homepage. The interactive U.S. map renders. Cursor clicks Florida → rep page opens.]

[Voiceover, calm and direct] Most Americans can't name their state senator. Most don't know how their congressperson voted on the last major bill.

[Screen: switches to a federal rep's page with voting record visible.]

That isn't because people don't care. It's because the data is scattered across hundreds of government websites and paid news terminals.

[Screen: bill detail page, with the Haiku-translated plain-English summary unfurling.]

CivicView puts it in one place. Every member of Congress, every state legislator in all 50 states, every executive order, every Supreme Court justice — with AI-translated plain-English summaries on top.

[Screen: poll page, citizen authoring a poll with "Unverified" badge visible.]

Once we add ID.me verification, verified citizens get to weigh in on their rep's page as actual constituents. That's the unlock.

[Screen: the /help-build page, scrolling through the funding line items.]

No ads. No venture capital. No partisan agenda. Florida Benefit Corp, source open on GitHub, every funding line audited in public.

[Cut to founder, on camera, plain background.]

I'm Jeffrey De La Nuez. I built this myself over the last six months. The \$25K we're raising covers Year 2 of operations — that's it. If you care about civic infrastructure that isn't owned by anyone, help me ship it.

[End card: civicview.app + Indiegogo link]

8. Notes for the publisher (Jeff)

- **Indiegogo fees:** 5% platform fee + payment processing (~3% + \$0.30 per contribution), deducted at disbursement. On a fully funded \$25K campaign that's roughly \$2,000 in fees — budget for it; the goal you set is the gross, not the net.
- **Flexible vs Fixed:** we chose **Flexible** so we keep funds even if we miss goal. The trade-off Indiegogo historically attached (a higher fee on under-goal Flexible campaigns) no longer applies — the platform fee is a flat 5% either way as of 2026. Confirm on the funding step before publishing.
- **Disbursement:** Indiegogo pays out via its Stripe-backed system after the campaign ends (Flexible campaigns can have funds released on a schedule). Verify the exact cadence in the dashboard; plan cash needs around it, not around daily access.
- **Payee = the corporation.** Link the CivicView business bank account, not personal. Contributions are revenue to the corporation, not personal income; the corporation may owe state taxes depending on FL Benefit Corp treatment — confirm with the same attorney who reviews the Terms of Service.
- **Don't open the campaign before EIN + business bank account land** — Indiegogo's identity/bank verification gate means you can't collect funds without them anyway, and running it through a personal account creates an accounting cleanup that isn't worth the impatience.
- **Pre-launch test:** ask 3–5 trusted friends to read the Story and give 30-second feedback. They'll catch tone issues you've gone blind to.

- **Day-1 momentum** is the single biggest predictor of campaign success. Pre-line up at least 5 supporters willing to contribute within the first 2 hours so the page doesn't show \$0 to early visitors.
- **InDemand** is the post-campaign continuation feature — opt in at campaign close to keep accepting contributions toward the buffer without re-launching.